PAC Tools

User guide

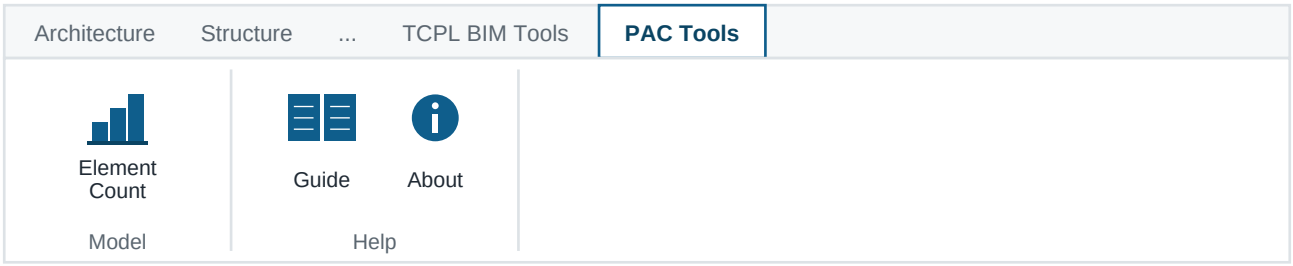
Version 0.1.0 | Revit 2025 and 2026 | Tandon Consultants Pvt. Ltd.

1. What PAC Tools is

PAC Tools is a Revit add-in by Tandon Consultants Pvt. Ltd. It adds its own **PAC Tools** tab to the Revit ribbon. Its purpose is to connect Excel spreadsheets to Revit schedules.

> **What works in this version.** The Excel tools are not available yet. Version 0.1.0 contains **Element Count**, **Guide** and **About**. Section 6 describes what is planned.

The PAC Tools tab



The tab and its buttons. This is a drawing, not a screenshot.

Button	Panel	What it does	Changes the model?
Element Count	Model	Counts elements per category, for the active view or the whole model.	No
Guide	Help	Opens this PDF.	No
About	Help	Shows the version number and where the log file is.	No

2. Install, update and remove

You need

- Revit 2025 or 2026. Older versions are not supported.
- The .NET 8 SDK, because the installer builds the add-in on your PC. The SDK is needed, not only the runtime.
- A copy of the PAC-Tools repository. Administrator rights are not needed: files go only into your own user profile.

Install or update

1. **Save your work and close Revit.** The installer stops if Revit is running.
2. Double-click `install\Install-PACTools.bat` in the repository. It builds the add-in, copies it in, and checks that the installed copy matches the build.
3. Start Revit. If it asks about an unknown add-in, choose **Always Load**.
4. Open a project and look for the **PAC Tools** tab.

For Revit 2026, run this from a terminal in the repository folder instead:

```
powershell -NoProfile -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install\install.ps1 -RevitVersion 2026
```

Remove

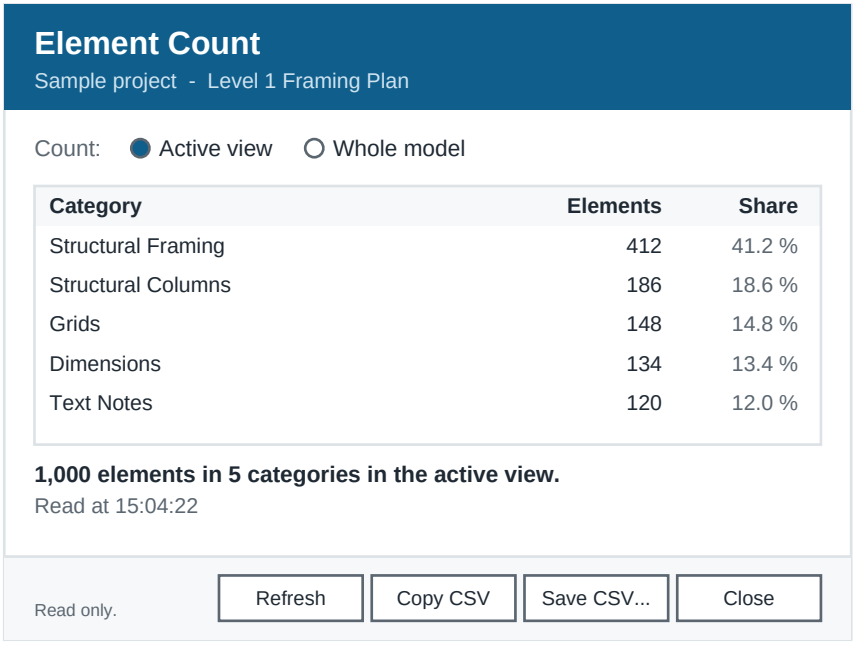
Close Revit and double-click `install\Uninstall-PACTools.bat`. This removes the add-in only. Your projects are not touched.

3. Element Count

Element Count shows how many elements a view or a model contains, grouped by category. Use it to get a quick picture of what is in a model, or to bring those numbers into Excel. It only reads the model, so it cannot change anything and there is nothing to undo.

How to use it

1. With a project open, click **PAC Tools › Model › Element Count**. The window opens and reads the active view.
2. Choose **Active view** or **Whole model**. The table updates straight away.
3. Carry on working in Revit if you like: the window can stay open. After you change the model or the view, press **Refresh**. The table does not update by itself.
4. To take the numbers to Excel, press **Copy CSV** and paste, or press **Save CSV...** to save a file.



The Element Count window. This is a drawing with invented numbers, not a screenshot.

The window

Item	What it does
Active view	Counts what belongs to the view currently open in Revit.
Whole model	Counts every element in the project, in every view.
Elements / Share	How many elements are in the category, and what percentage of the total that is. The biggest category comes first.
Refresh	Reads the model again. While it waits for Revit the window shows *waiting for Revit...* If Revit is busy, for example in the middle of a command, the read happens when you finish.
Copy CSV	Puts the table on the clipboard, ready to paste into Excel.
Save CSV...	Saves the table as a .csv file, with a file name suggested from the project and view.
Close	Closes the window. It also closes by itself when you close the project.

Reading the numbers

- **Whole model counts more than you might expect.** It counts all instances, including non-modelled ones such as views, sheets, levels and annotation. Element types (family types) are never counted.
- **(no category)** is the row for elements Revit does not assign to any category.
- **Linked models are not counted.** A link counts as one element in the host model; the elements inside it are not included.
- The CSV has the columns **Category, Elements, Share**, and a **Total** row at the end.

If you press the button when the window is already open, the open window comes to the front instead of a second one opening.

4. Guide

PAC Tools › Help › Guide opens this PDF in your PDF reader. The file is installed with the add-in, so it works without internet access.

5. About

PAC Tools › Help › About shows the version you have and where the log file is. Quote the version number when you report a problem.

6. Planned: Excel to schedule

> **Not available yet.** This section describes the plan, and details may change.

- **Import spreadsheet data.** Pick a workbook and worksheet, map the columns, and get a Revit schedule.
- **Refresh linked data.** The link to the workbook is remembered, so the schedule can be refreshed when the sheet changes.
- **Schedules from a selection.** A named table, a named range or a typed range becomes its own schedule.

Planned formats are .xlsx, .xlsm, .xls (read-only) and .csv. Excel will not need to be installed.

7. Troubleshooting

What you see	What to do
No PAC Tools tab	Check that you are in Revit 2025 or 2026 and that you restarted Revit after installing. If you chose not to load the add-in at the prompt, restart Revit and choose Always Load. Then check the log file below.
Installer: *Revit is running*	Save your work, close every Revit window and run it again.
Installer: *.NET SDK is not installed*	Install the .NET 8 SDK, close and reopen the window, and run it again.
Installer: *RevitAPI.dll was not found*	Revit is not in the usual folder, or it is a different version. The message lists the versions it found and the option to use.
Open a Revit project first	Element Count needs an open project.
works in project documents, not in the family editor	Switch to a project. Element Count does not run on families.
Red box: *the elements of the view cannot be counted*	Some views, such as schedules, cannot be counted. Switch to a plan, section, elevation or 3D view, or choose Whole model.
Red box: *Windows would not give up the clipboard*	Another program is holding the clipboard. Try again in a moment.
Guide says the file is missing	Run the installer again. The PDF should sit next to `PacTools.dll`.

Where the files are

File	Location
Log file	`%LocalAppData%\PACTools\logs\pactools.log`
Add-in	`%AppData%\Autodesk\Revit\Addins\<version>\PacTools\`
Manifest	`%AppData%\Autodesk\Revit\Addins\<version>\PacTools.addin`